Group Project Rubric: seven lenses, four components

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Course: New Media Technology and Analytics (20001920076) ·**Fall 2026** ·Group project ·*Governing documents:* `project_brief.md`, `ai_use_policy.pdf`.

How your grade is built. The project is marked out of 100, split across four components. Four abbreviations appear in the tables below: artificial intelligence (AI), Chinese yuan (CNY), questions and answers (Q&A), and segmentation, targeting and positioning (STP).

Component	Points	Scored by
Project report (8-12 pages)	40	Instructor
Pitch (8 min + 3 min Q&A)	30	Instructor
Technical work (data, code, and a reproducible notebook)	20	Instructor
Investor vote (see the paragraph at the end)	10	Peers

Seven quality lenses cut across the instructor-scored components; they define what "excellent" looks like instead of forming separate line items. The mapping:

Lens	Feeds
Business relevance	Report (40)
Methodological correctness	Report (40) + Technical work (20)
Theory framing	Report (40)
Actionability	Report (40)
Communication	Pitch (30)
AI-use craft	Technical work (20)
Ethics & compliance	Report (40) + Pitch (30)

Within each component, the level reached on its lenses sets the score: **excellent** earns essentially full points,

good about 85%, **developing** about 65%, **weak** about 40%.

Business relevance: feeds the report (40)

Level	Descriptor
Excellent	A real decision is at stake, quantified in CNY, users, or risk; a manager would pay to hear the answer
Good	A real business question; stakes asserted but only partly quantified
Developing	Business frame present but generic; the stakes stay vague
Weak	A dataset in search of a question

Methodological correctness: feeds the report (40) and the technical work (20)

Level	Descriptor
Excellent	The method fits the question; assumptions are stated and checked; cleaning is documented; the notebook passes Restart & Run All
Good	The right method, with minor gaps in checks or documentation that do not move the conclusion
Developing	The method is applied with errors that spare the headline, or the checks are missing
Weak	The wrong method, or claims the analysis does not support

Theory framing: feeds the report (40)

Level	Descriptor
Excellent	A named theory (4Cs, STP, customer lifetime value, parasocial trust, network effects, …) explains why the finding should hold, and the analysis tests what the theory predicts
Good	A theory is named and genuinely connected, if loosely
Developing	A theory is mentioned but decorative; remove it and nothing changes
Weak	No theory, or a buzzword

Actionability: feeds the report (40)

Level	Descriptor
Excellent	A Monday-morning recommendation: who does what, how large the effect should be, and its limits
Good	A clear recommendation, with the size or the limits argued thinly
Developing	A generic recommendation (“improve engagement”, “do more marketing”)
Weak	The report ends at the model output

Communication: feeds the pitch (30)

Level	Descriptor
Excellent	An executive could follow it; the visuals carry the argument; honest about limits; any member can answer any question
Good	Understandable but dense in places; Q&A uneven across members
Developing	Jargon-heavy; one member carries the Q&A while the others spectate
Weak	Reads like a code dump; the team cannot defend its own work

AI-use craft: feeds the technical work (20)

Level	Descriptor
Excellent	Deliberate, disclosed AI use per the AI Use Policy; every shipped line is explainable; the AI-use appendix is complete
Good	AI used and disclosed; a few parts thinly explained
Developing	Disclosure incomplete, or artifacts in the notebook the team explains poorly
Weak	Undisclosed AI use, or work the team cannot explain. This is also a policy violation

Ethics & compliance: feeds the report (40) and the pitch (30)

Every team must address the ethical and compliance implications of its own topic (privacy, algorithmic bias, and misinformation) in both the report and the pitch (author decision 2026-09-09; this lens carries ILO5).

Level	Descriptor
Excellent	The team names the stakes specific to its topic and platform, ties them to its own data and recommendation, and states the safeguard a manager should actually adopt
Good	The relevant issues are identified and discussed, but the link to the team's own analysis or recommendation is thin
Developing	A generic ethics paragraph that could belong to any project; remove it and nothing changes
Weak	No treatment, or a claim the team's own data handling contradicts

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The investor vote (10 points). During the presentations, each student plays the role of an investor: for every one of the other 11 teams you decide **support** or **not**, guided by a single question: "would I put my own money behind what this team does next?" Choosing **not** obliges you to give the reason in one sentence, out loud. Investors owe founders honesty. Your team's investor component is the share of support votes cast for you, converted to the 10-point component (for example, 9 support votes out of 12 cast = 75%, which scores 7.5 of 10). Collusive or reciprocal voting voids the votes.